

Story

Super Store Returns Presentation	Summary	Total Sales & Total Returns by Product S..	Avg Return Rate (Product Category)	Return Rate by Customer	Return Rate By State	Return Rate By Month
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Super Store Returns
by
Dr. Clinton Bullock

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1) How should returns be measured?

Returns should be measured using something called the **"return rate."**

That's just the percentage of orders that got returned out of all orders.

For example, if 100 customers bought something and 10 returned it, the return rate is 10%.

We calculate this using a simple formula:

Return Rate = (Number of Returned Orders) ÷ (Total Orders)

We created this using a **"Return Indicator,"** where:

“Yes” = 1 (returned)

“Null” = 0 (not returned)

2) Is the return rate, total cost of returns, or number of returns a better measure?

Each one tells you something different, but the **return rate is usually best.**

Return Rate is best when you want to compare fairly (eg: between states, categories, or time periods). It's a percentage. So, it doesn't get skewed by high-volume areas.

Total Cost of Returns is useful for finance to see how much money you're losing from returns.

Total Number of Returns is fine. However, it can be misleading if one group just has more sales overall.

3) When is one better than the other?

We use **Return Rate** when we're comparing across categories, months, customers, etc.

Eg: Technology has more returns than Furniture. However, is this because it sells more?

We use **Total Cost of Returns** when we're trying to calculate the financial impact.

Eg: Returns in August cost \$2,500, which is the highest of any month.

We use **Total Number of Returns** when we care about workload or volume.

Eg: How many packages are being returned to our warehouse?

4) What are the key root causes of returns (based on the dashboard)?

Based on the charts and visualizations:

Product-based causes:

Binders, Tables, and Machines had high return rates. These might be bulky, defective, or not meeting expectations.

Customer-based causes:

Some **customers with more than 1 order** returned more frequently. They may have different shopping habits or be more picky.

Geographic causes:

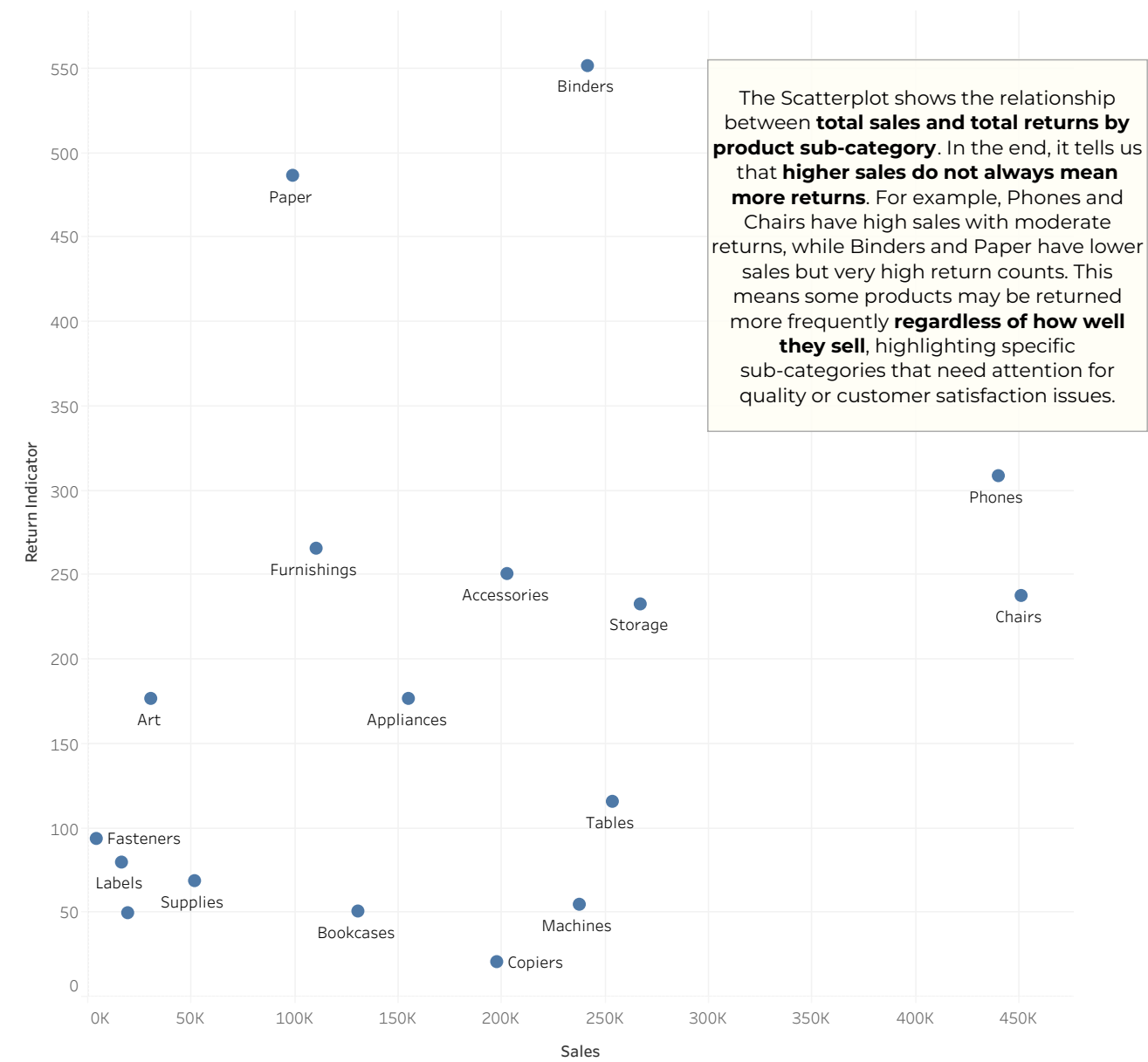
Some **states, such as California and Texas** had higher return rates. This may be due to population size, shipping issues, or regional preferences.

Time-based causes:

August and September saw spikes in return rates. This could be back-to-school season or post-summer returns.

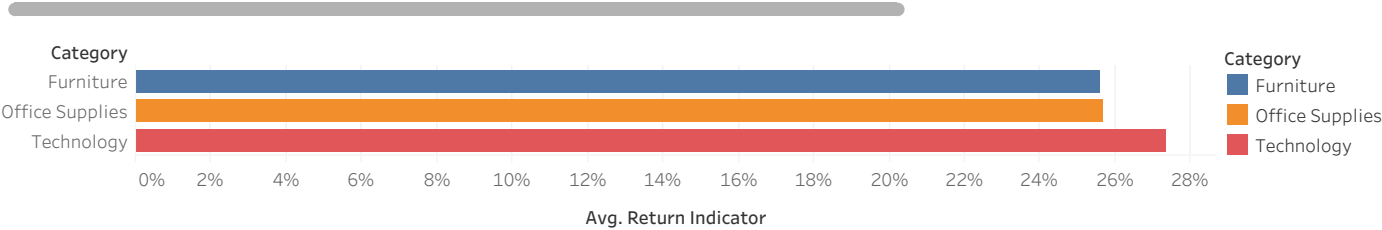
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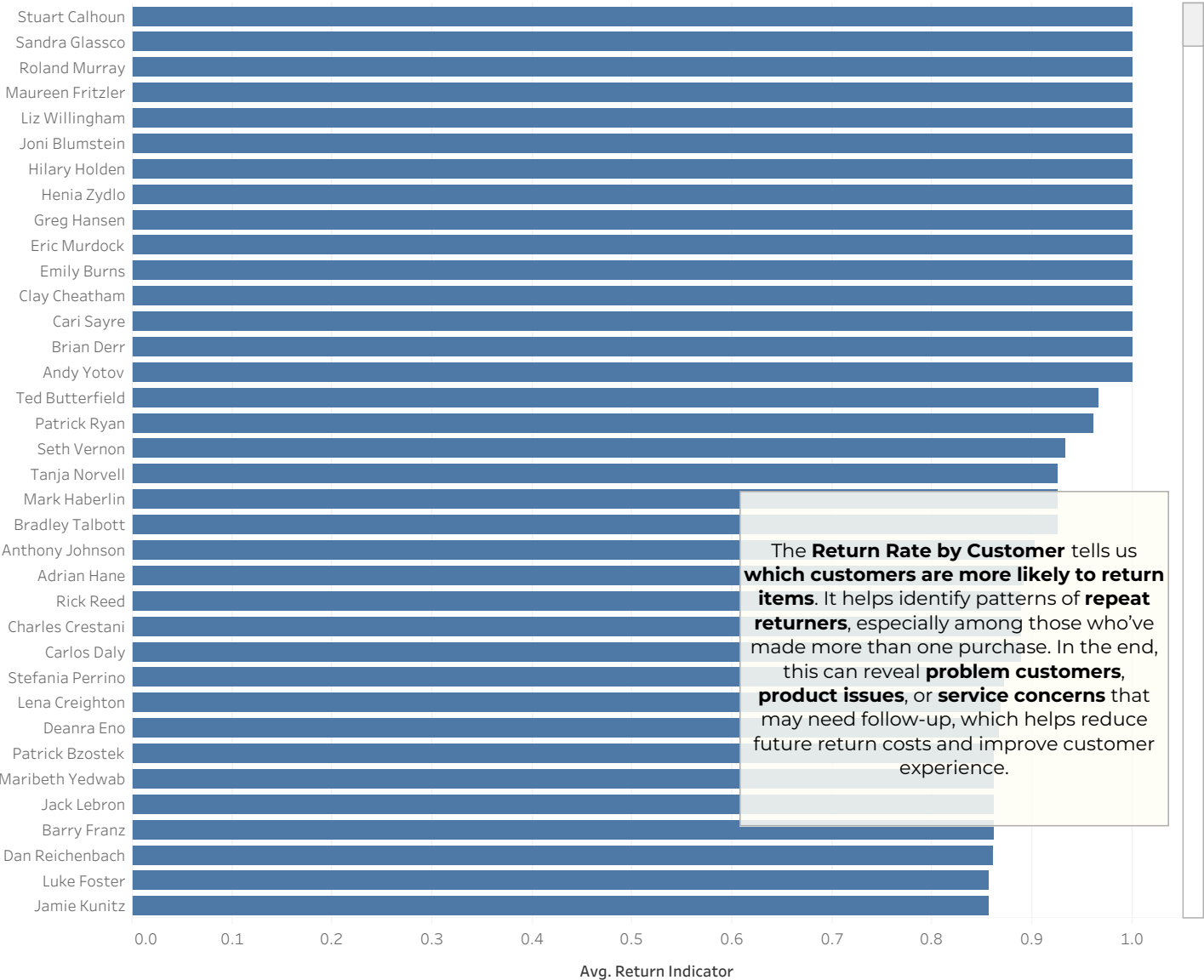


The Bar Chart shows the **average return rate by product category** and reveals that **Technology has the highest return rate**, followed by **Office Supplies**, then **Furniture**. In the end, this tells us that returns are not evenly distributed across categories, and that **Technology products may need closer review for quality issues, customer expectations, or product descriptions**, as they are being returned more often.

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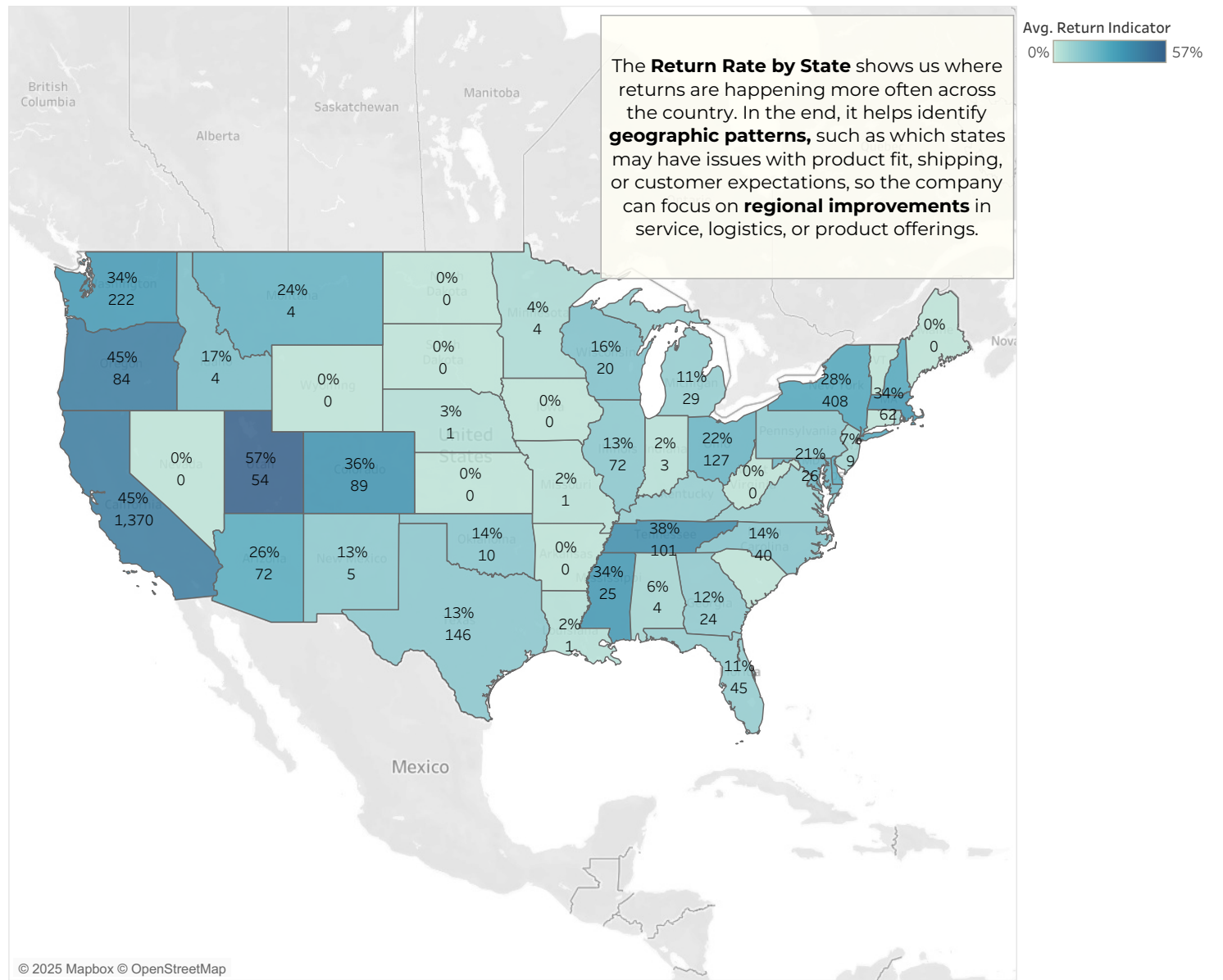
Summary	Total Sales & Total Returns by Product S..	Avg Return Rate (Product Category)	Return Rate by Customer	Return Rate By State	Return Rate By Month	Month & Category (Clustered Bar)
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Customer Name



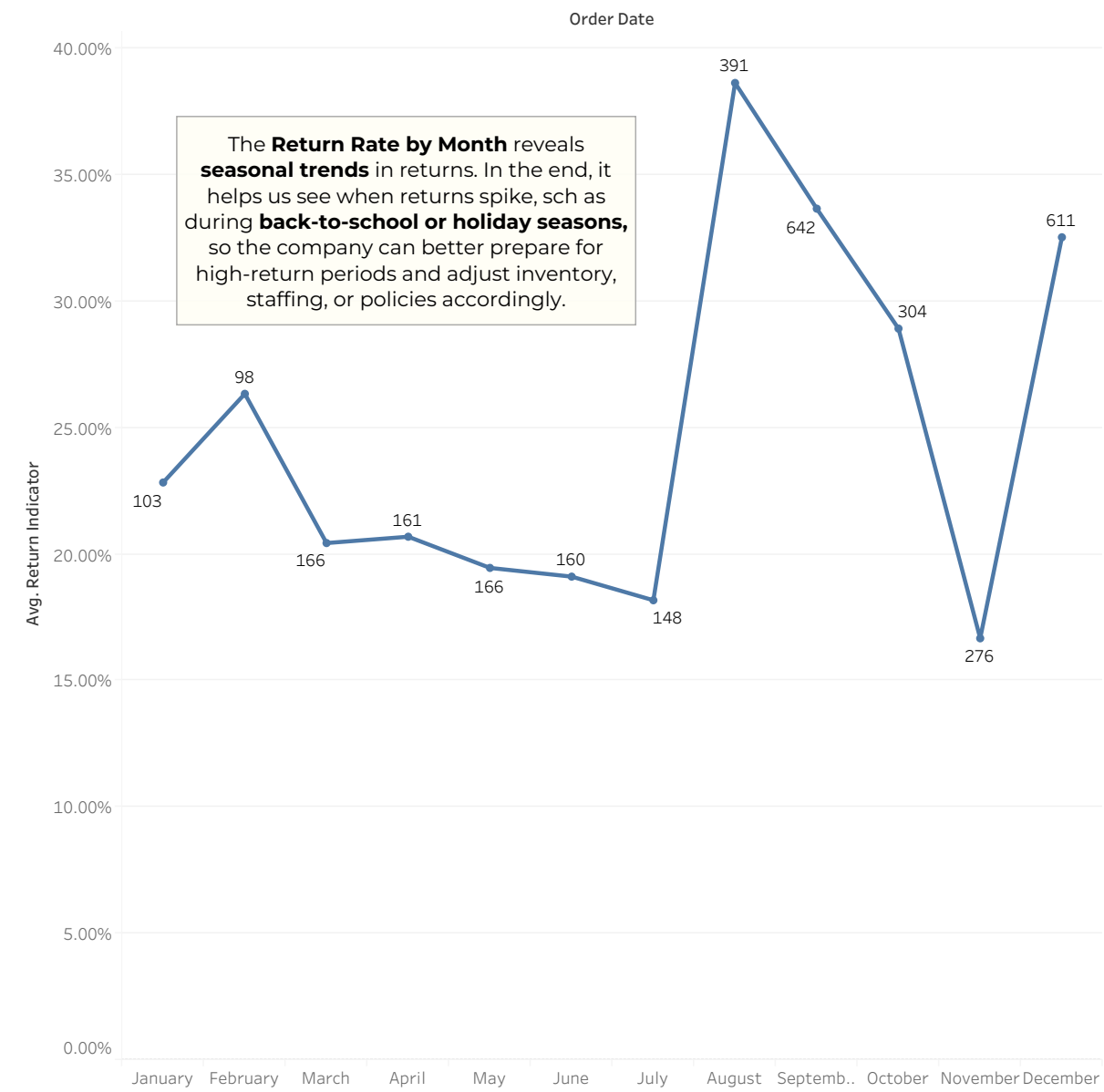
Story

Total Sales & Total Returns by..	Avg Return Rate (Product Category)	Return Rate by Customer	Return Rate By State	Return Rate By Month	Month & Category (Clustered Bar)	Dashboard
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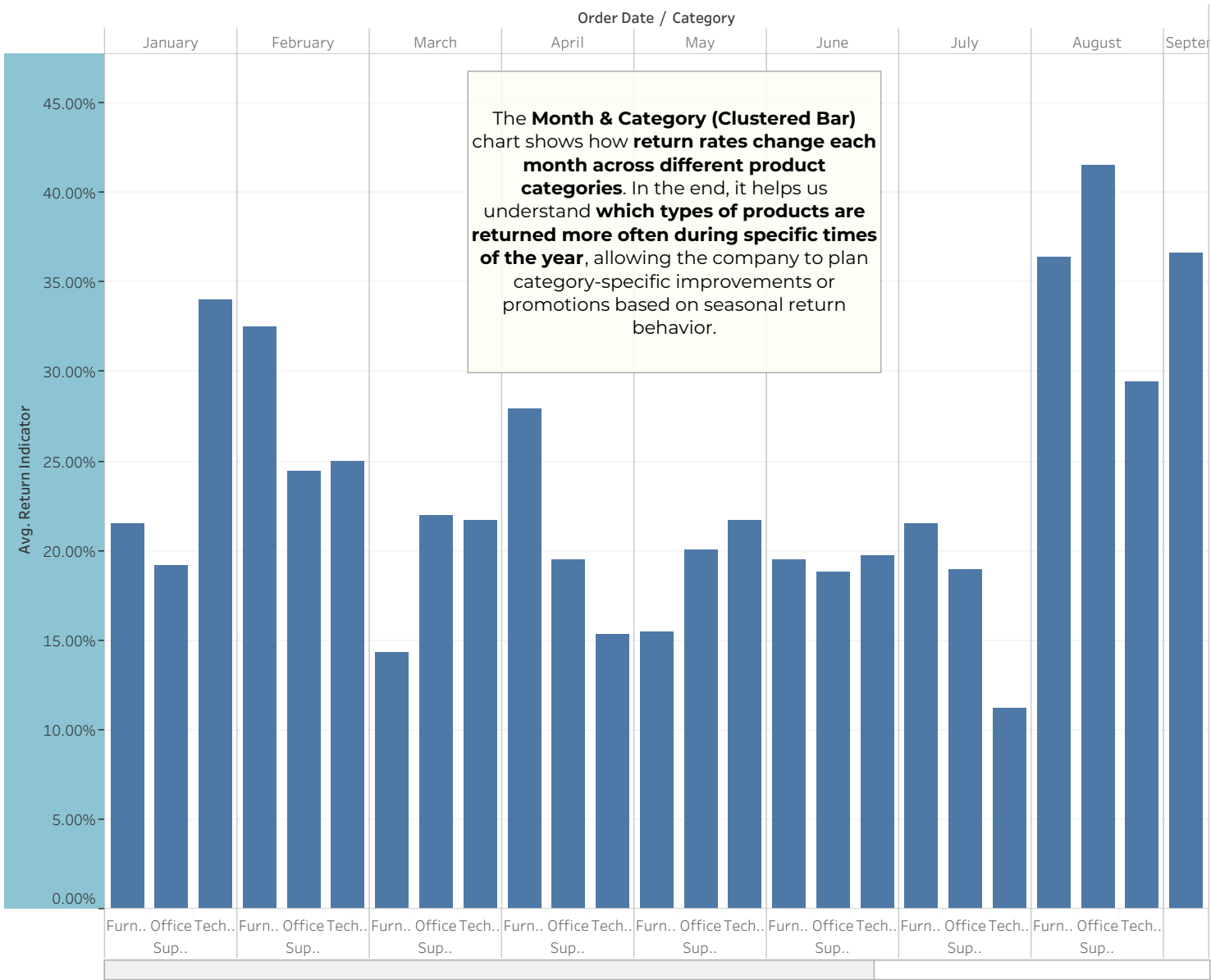
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Avg Return Rate (Product Catego..	Return Rate by Customer	Return Rate By State	Return Rate By Month	Month & Category (Clustered Bar)	Dashboard	Explanation of the Dashboard
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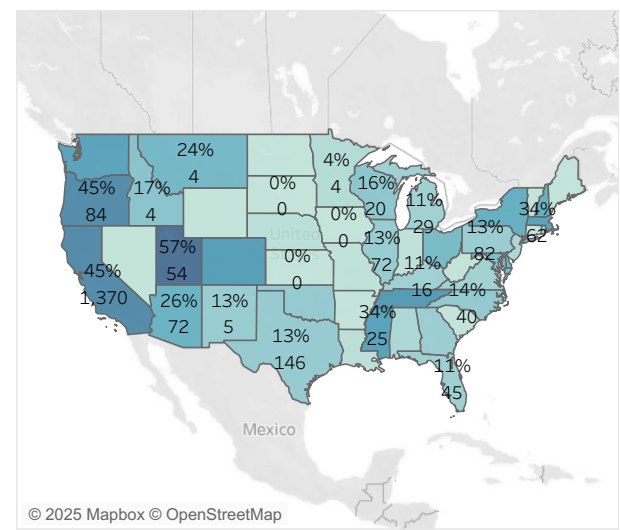
Return Rate by Customer	Return Rate By State	Return Rate By Month	Month & Category (Clustered Bar)	Dashboard	Explanation of the Dashboard	Conclusion
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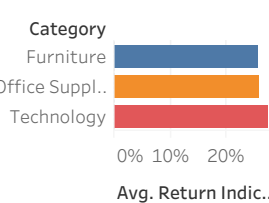
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Return Rate by Customer	Return Rate By State	Return Rate By Month	Month & Category (Clustered Bar)	Dashboard	Explanation of the Dashboard	Conclusion
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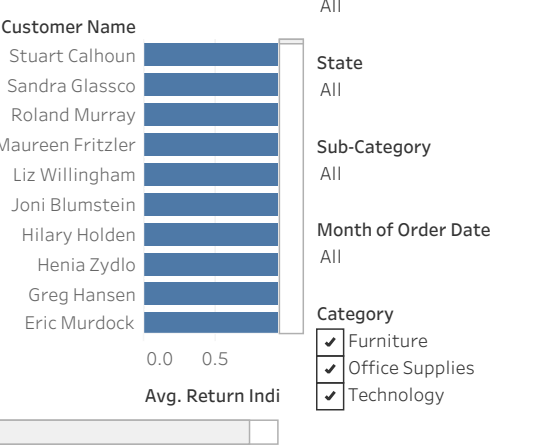
Return Rate by State



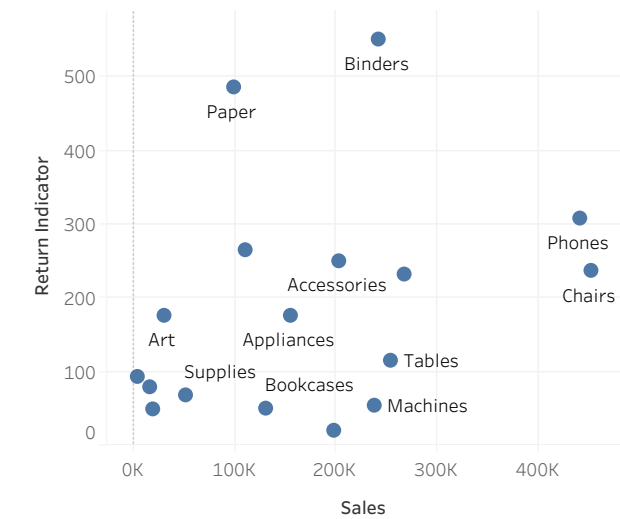
Bar Chart



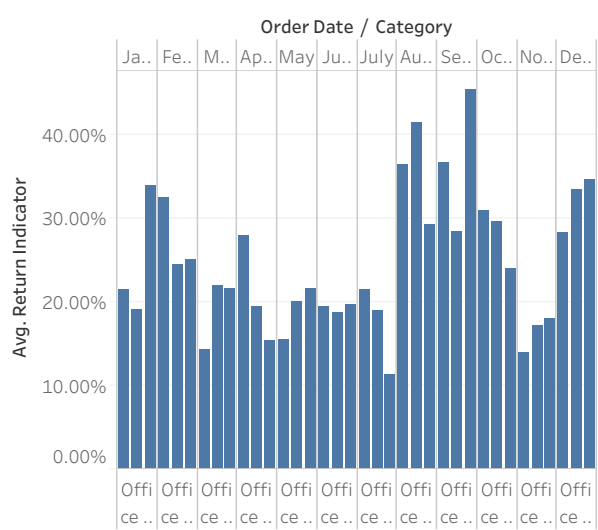
Return Rate by Customer (2+ Orders)



Scatterplot



Month & Category (Clustered Bar)



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The Dashboard can be used as an interactive tool designed to help us easily monitor and analyze product returns across multiple dimensions.

To use it effectively, we can begin by reviewing each visual, such as return rate by state, customer, month, and product category, to identify where return problems may be concentrated. Filters placed on the dashboard, such as by category, state, or date range, allow users to narrow down the data and pinpoint specific causes of high return rates.

For example, by selecting a certain product category and state, we can observe how return patterns shift and isolate whether the issue is product-related, regional, or seasonal.

Interacting with the dashboard is simple: We can click on chart elements (eg: a specific bar or region) or use dropdown filters to dynamically update the entire dashboard. This makes the dashboard not just something to look at, but something to explore and act on.

Once root causes are identified (for instance, a particular product returned frequently in a certain state), we can take specific actions, such as improving product descriptions, modifying return policies, adjusting inventory, or targeting customer feedback in those regions.

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Return Rate by Customer	Return Rate By State	Return Rate By Month	Month & Category (Clustered Bar)	Dashboard	Explanation of the Dashboard	Conclusion
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In conclusion, the implementation of the returns dashboard provides us with a powerful, interactive tool to monitor and respond to return trends in real time.

As a next step, the dashboard should be integrated into regular business reviews and made accessible to key teams such as operations, customer service, and inventory management.

It is recommended that the company actively use the dashboard to identify high-return products, problematic regions, and seasonal spikes in returns so targeted strategies can be developed. For instance, if return rates increase during certain months, the dashboard can help reveal which product categories are driving those spikes, allowing for better planning and adjustments in marketing, stocking, or customer education.

Ultimately, the company should focus on reducing its overall return rate by addressing root causes, using the dashboard insights to implement product improvements, streamline shipping practices, and refine return policies where necessary.